

The last night.



THE NIGHT _____

Where _____

Whose place _____

Doors _____ Ends _____

How many _____

Dress _____

Music by _____

Budget _____

WHAT KIND OF NIGHT IS THIS _____ Decide it now

- ☐ A party
- ☐ Six people and a good dinner
- ☐ Out, then back here
- ☐ Children up till midnight
- ☐ Two of us and something better than usual
- ☐ Asleep by eleven, on purpose

MIDNIGHT ITSELF _____ Decide it in advance

The two things that ruin New Year’s Eve

Not enough to eat after eleven, and no way home. Everything else is decoration. Page 3 puts food on the table twice, and page 2 asks every guest how they are getting home **before** they arrive — because at one in the morning on the first of January there are no taxis, and there is no talking anyone out of driving.

BOOKED, ORDERED, PAID FOR _____

- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____
- ☐ _____

THE BITS THAT MAKE IT FEEL LIKE NEW YEAR

- ☐ Something fizzy, and something fizzy without alcohol
- ☐ Enough glasses out before eleven
- ☐ Whatever is on the television, found in advance
- ☐ A song for the first minute of the year
- ☐ A photograph, taken before everyone is tired

TOMORROW MORNING _____ Set it up tonight



Date  2/9

"How are you getting home?"

#	NAME	GETTING HOME HOW	INV	YES	NO	BED	BRINGING
01			☐	☐	☐	☐	
02			☐	☐	☐	☐	
03			☐	☐	☐	☐	
04			☐	☐	☐	☐	
05			☐	☐	☐	☐	
06			☐	☐	☐	☐	
07			☐	☐	☐	☐	
08			☐	☐	☐	☐	
09			☐	☐	☐	☐	
10			☐	☐	☐	☐	
11			☐	☐	☐	☐	
12			☐	☐	☐	☐	
13			☐	☐	☐	☐	
14			☐	☐	☐	☐	
15			☐	☐	☐	☐	
16			☐	☐	☐	☐	
17			☐	☐	☐	☐	
18			☐	☐	☐	☐	
19			☐	☐	☐	☐	
20			☐	☐	☐	☐	

DRIVING

Tick the **Bed** column for anyone who might stay, and count them now rather than at midnight. Two people who planned to drive and changed their minds is the usual number. Blankets, a spare toothbrush and somewhere dark to sleep cost you nothing in advance and are impossible to produce at two in the morning.

An analog clock face with a black border and tick marks. The hour hand is between 11 and 12, and the minute hand is at 11. The time is 11:55.

3/9

oo:oo

The only fixed deadline in the whole shop

Start at eight and work down

WHAT HAPPENS

WHO IS ON IT

Write the time next to each

- 1
Food out, the first time
Before anyone has had three drinks
- 2
Music up, lights down
The room changes or it does not
- 3
Glasses out, all of them
Counted, on a table, not in a cupboard
- 4
Bottles opened and poured
Ten minutes before, not on the hour
- 5
Everyone into one room
The hardest five minutes of the night
- 6
MIDNIGHT
Whatever you decided on page 1
- 7
Phone calls and messages
The network is busy; give it ten minutes
- 8
Food out, the second time
This is the one people remember
- 9
Taxis, coats, beds
Say it out loud once, kindly



Date  4/9

Grazing, not a sit-down

WHO

GOT

Hot, salty, and made in advance

The second round of food is the one people talk about the next day. It does not have to be clever — it has to exist, and it has to appear without anybody cooking at half past midnight.

One bottle is about six flutes

PEOPLE

FOR THE
TOAST

THE WHOLE EVENING

☐	6 people	1 bottle	3 bottles
☐	12 people	2 bottles	6 bottles
☐	20 people	4 bottles	10 bottles
☐	30 people	5 bottles	15 bottles

The evening column assumes about half a bottle of wine a head across the night. Round up. Nobody has ever regretted one bottle too many in the cupboard on the second of January.

Count them properly; make it as good

ICE, GLASSES, AND THE REST

- ☐ More ice than you believe
- ☐ Glasses counted, and a marker to name them
- ☐ A bottle opener that is not lost
- ☐ Bin bags out early, one for the glass

The year, in twelve lines.

Date



5/9

ONE LINE EACH — The first thing you think of, not the best

January

February

March

April

May

June

July

August

September

October

November

December

Use a calendar, not your memory

Scroll back through your own photographs, or your diary, one month at a time. Almost nobody can remember March in December, and the year always turns out to have had more in it than it felt like. That is the point of the page.

BETTER THAN EXPECTED

HARDER THAN EXPECTED

PEOPLE WHO MATTERED THIS YEAR

SOMETHING YOU FINISHED — Even if nobody noticed



6/9

A list of new things to start, on top of a year that is already full, is how January resolutions die by February. Before you add anything, take something off. Write down what you are putting down, and where it is written matters: a thing dropped on paper is dropped, a thing dropped in your head comes back.

WHAT	PER MONTH	CANCELLED
------	-----------	-----------

Next year, on one page.

Date



7/9

ONE TO START, ONE TO STOP, ONE TO FINISH —

START

STOP

FINISH

THE FOUR QUARTERS — A phrase each

WHEN	WHAT IT IS FOR	IN A WORD
------	----------------	-----------

Jan - Mar

Apr - Jun

Jul - Sep

Oct - Dec

ALREADY IN THE DIARY — Birthdays, trips, deadlines

WHAT	WHEN	BOOKED
------	------	--------

		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐
		☐

MONEY, DECIDED IN JANUARY —

Saving towards

How much a month

Paying off

By when

One thing worth the money

SOMETHING TO LEARN, BADLY —

PEOPLE TO SEE MORE OF — Put a month next to each

IF THE YEAR GOES BADLY — Written while it is easy

Date  8/9

Renewals fall due, prices go up quietly, and the diary is empty enough to actually do something about it. An hour spent here in the first week is worth more than any resolution on this list.

WHAT	RENEWS	NEW PRICE	DONE
------	--------	-----------	------

[illegible]

WHAT	DUE	ROUGHLY	DONE
------	-----	---------	------

QUESTION	ANSWER	SCORE
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐
_____	_____	☐

☐ Birthdays into next year's calendar, all of them

☐ Passports and licences — check the expiry dates

☐ The medicine cabinet, and anything out of date

- Photographs backed up somewhere that is not the phone

☐ Appointments booked while the diary is empty

☐ One drawer, emptied

BOOKED IN JANUARY BECAUSE IT IS CHEAP

☐ _____

☐ [View all posts by](#) [Amanda](#)

☐ _____

PUT AWAY, AND WHERE • The decorations, and this kit

The first of January.

Date



9/9

HOW THE NIGHT WENT

Write it today

DO AGAIN NEXT YEAR

☐

☐

☐

☐

DO NOT DO AGAIN

☐

☐

☐

TODAY, AND NOTHING MORE

- ☐ Water, and something to eat that is not sweet
- ☐ Outside for twenty minutes, whatever the weather
- ☐ The glasses washed before the evening
- ☐ Whoever stayed, fed before they drive
- ☐ Nothing started today; the diary begins tomorrow

MESSAGES WORTH SENDING TODAY

ONE LINE FOR THE YEAR THAT HAS STARTED

Save your filled-in copy. Next December, page 5 opens with this year's twelve lines already in it, and the year does not vanish.